

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's ask the focus group that question.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you been part of a focus group? Would you like to be?
- What are other ways companies get information about people's opinions on their products and services?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about the present result of events that started in the past in work and job issues.
- I can talk about uncertainty in past events related to job issues.
- I can explain arguments supporting different points of view.

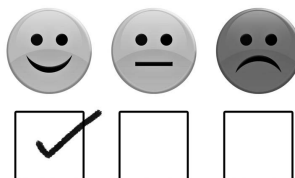




Let's Explore!

Denise and Boris review the **transcript*** of the focus group session.

* A "transcript" is the written account of things that were said orally, such as during a meeting.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Denise:** I am concerned about our sales in financial literacy, Boris.
- Boris:** Really? It's early yet to be concerned, don't you think?
- Denise:** Perhaps I was really excited about this project when we received the manuscript. Our market research showed that this was an area of need in the school system.
- Boris:** So what's the problem?
- Denise:** It appears the reaction to my pitch has been lukewarm at best. People may not have understood the importance of teaching financial literacy.
- Boris:** Since there is no time allotted for that in the school timetable, it must have been ignored in the past.
- Denise:** Exactly. We knew that would be a marketing challenge.
- Boris:** The transcript of our recent focus group is just in. Do you want to look at a few comments?
- Denise:** Sure! That might give us some good ideas.
- Boris:** One participant said: "I like the design and choice of colors. The explanations appear clear and consistent. It seems as if the articles have been written with the grade level in mind. My concern is that the lexical items in the glossary might have been more complete, and you may have included page references. That would have been helpful."
- Denise:** Mmmm that's interesting. Here's another one: "These are excellent learning materials for a topic that is difficult to explain. I appreciate the real-life situations that are included in each chapter. I think the material could have included more biographies in the workbook related to history. Did you consider examining the life of Muhammad Yunus, economist and inventor of microcredit? He won a Nobel prize for his work."
- Boris:** It sounds as if the focus group participants have taken their role very seriously. Let's read one more. "I love teaching financial literacy. Your materials will help me teach more complicated notions, like supply and demand, interest rates and taxation. However, some chapters may have been better researched. The chapter on bankruptcy is misleading."
- Denise:** Ouch!





Let's Practice!

What does the focus group say?

Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is Denise worried about?
 - a. She is worried about Boris.
 - b. She is worried about receiving the final manuscript.
 - c. She is worried about lukewarm sales.
 - d. She is worried about the market research.
2. Why did PBF Publishing start the project on financial literacy?
 - a. The market research suggested it was an area of need.
 - b. There is no time allotted for it in the timetable.
 - c. Denise thinks it is interesting.
 - d. The focus group said it was important.
3. The workbooks in financial literacy....
 - a. include a biography on Muhammad Yunus.
 - b. have a chapter on focus groups.
 - c. talk about microcredit.
 - d. have a glossary.
4. One suggestion for improvement is ...
 - a. including lexical items.
 - b. including page references.
 - c. including articles written for each grade level.
 - d. adding material on supply and demand.
5. The workbooks are useful to teach students about ...
 - a. microcredit.
 - b. taxation.
 - c. bankruptcy.
 - d. Nobel prizes.



Let's Practice!

The focus group participants make some comments.

Instructions: Write the correct form of the verb in the parenthesis to complete the sentences. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. People may not have _____ (to understand) the importance of teaching financial literacy.
2. Since there is no time allotted for that in the school timetable, it must have _____ (to be) ignored in the past.
3. My concern is that the lexical items in the glossary might have _____ (to be) more complete, and you may have included page references.
4. I think the material could have _____ (to include) more biographies in the workbook related to history.
5. Some chapters may have been better _____ (to research).





Extension Activity

Give your opinion on a publication as if you are in a focus group.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose any publication. It could be a reference book, a textbook, a brochure, a cookbook, etc.
- Write a 80 - 120-word paragraph giving your opinion on the publication. Say what you think is good and not good about it.
- Give specific comments about different parts of the publication. Try to use the words *chapter*, *glossary*, *index*, *cover page* and *illustrations*.
- Conclude your paragraph with an overall opinion.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write focus group comments using appropriate vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I say what I think is good about a publication.

☐ ☐

I say what I think is bad about a publication.

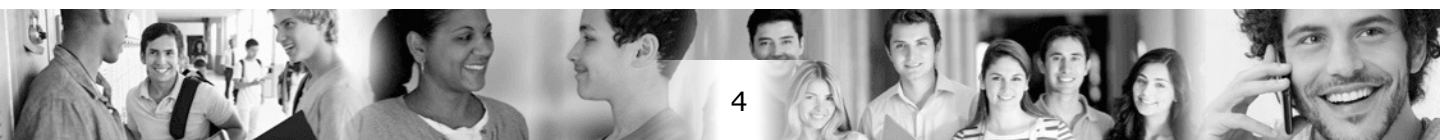
☐ ☐

I give my overall opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- lukewarm** (adjective): not very positive
e.g. It appears the reaction to my pitch has been lukewarm at best.
- lexical item** (noun): word in a list
e.g. My concern is that the lexical items in the glossary might have been more complete.
- page reference** (noun): in a book, in the glossary, the page number in which a word or topic appears
e.g. It would have been helpful to include page references.
- biography** (noun): information related to the life of an important person
e.g. I think the material could have included more biographies in the workbook related to history.
- bankruptcy** (noun): the inability to pay personal debts
e.g. The chapter on bankruptcy is misleading.
- microcredit** (noun): lending small amounts of money to help people start their own business
e.g. Did you consider examining the life of Muhammad Yunus, economist and inventor of microcredit?
- Nobel prize** (noun): a series of annual awards that are given in Sweden for extraordinary accomplishments
e.g. He won a Nobel prize for his work.
- to allot** (verb): to assign or to dedicate space, time or other resources
e.g. Since there is no time allotted for that, it must have been ignored in the past.
- timetable** (noun): the organization of events in a schedule including dates and time
e.g. This subject area is not covered in the school timetable.





Learning Points

Present Perfect to Talk About Results

You use the **Present Perfect** tense with the verbs *appear*, *seem* and *sound* to comment on the present results of something in the past.

The expression *It seems ...* can be followed by *as if* or *as though*.

For example:

*She **sounds** as though **she has had** a cold for days.*

*It **seems** they've **already decided** to go with another company.*

*It **appears** as if **they have been** hired to manage the group.*

Examples:

- *It appears the reaction to my pitch **has been** lukewarm at best.*
- *It seems as if the articles **have been written** with the grade level in mind.*
- *It sounds as if the focus group participants **have taken** their role very seriously.*

Talking About Uncertainty About the Past: Perfect Modal Verbs

Modal Perfects (modal + have + past participle) can refer to the past.

You use modal perfects in three ways.

Look at the chart for an outline of their usages.

Use	Example
to speculate about events, or to imagine the opposite happened	<i>I would have called him but I didn't have time. You should have told me you were going. You might have warned me.</i>
to talk about past events when we are not sure whether they happened or not	<i>I can't find my file - I suppose I could have left it somewhere at home. She must have given it to someone else.</i>
to talk about possibility in the present and future	<i>You should have already gone through customs by the time I get to the airport.</i>

Examples:

- *My concern is that the lexical items in the glossary **might have been** more complete, and you **may have included** page references.*
- *However, some chapters **may have been** better researched.*

